

E061

Strategic Project Management and Decision Making

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A company's strategy is to become the lowest-cost provider in its market. Four projects are proposed: (A) automate warehouse picking to cut labor costs 18%; (B) launch a luxury premium line; (C) redesign the corporate logo; (D) sponsor a regional golf tournament. Project B's sponsor is the longest-serving vice president. Which project best aligns with the strategy?

- A. Project B, because its sponsor has the most seniority.
- B. All four equally, since every project adds value.
- C. Project A, warehouse automation.
- D. Project C, the logo redesign.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

2.

Two mutually exclusive projects are proposed. Project X has an NPV of \$120,000 and costs \$500,000. Project Y has an NPV of \$90,000 and costs \$200,000. X's team lead just won a company award. Capital is not limited beyond choosing one. Which should be chosen on value?

- A. Project Y, because its NPV per dollar invested is higher.
- B. Project Y, because it costs less.
- C. Neither, since a positive NPV is not enough without payback under one year.
- D. Project X, because it has the higher NPV.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A project costs \$100,000 today and returns \$60,000 at the end of each of the next two years. At a 10% discount rate, what is its NPV?

- A. About \$4,132
- B. About \$104,132
- C. \$20,000
- D. About -\$4,132

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

4.

A software upgrade costs \$150,000. It saves \$50,000 in each of years 1 and 2 and \$100,000 in year 3. The vendor offers free training in the first month. What is the payback period?

- A. 1.5 years
- B. 0.33 years
- C. 2.5 years
- D. 3.0 years

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Project M pays back in 2 years. Project N pays back in 3 years but produces much larger cash flows after year 3. What is the main weakness of choosing M on payback alone?

- A. Payback ignores cash flows after the payback point and the time value of money.
- B. None; shorter payback always means higher value.
- C. Payback overstates the value of later cash flows.
- D. Payback measures profitability, so M is more profitable.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A training program cost \$80,000 and produced measurable gains of \$104,000 in its first year. The program was delivered at a resort venue. What is the first-year ROI?

- A. 23%
- B. 130%
- C. \$24,000
- D. 30%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A project must deliver a 25% ROI. It will cost \$240,000. What total gain is required?

- A. \$60,000
- B. \$240,000
- C. \$300,000
- D. \$192,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A PMO scores projects with weights Strategic fit 50%, Cost 30%, Risk 20%. Project P scores 9, 5, 4. Project Q scores 5, 8, 8. Q was proposed by the marketing team, which beat its targets last year. Which project ranks higher?

- A. Project Q, because marketing beat its targets.
- B. Project P, 6.8 vs. 6.5.
- C. Project Q, 21 vs. 18.
- D. Project Q, 6.8 vs. 6.5.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A model weights Fit at 60% and Cost at 40%. Project R scores 7 on Fit. What Cost score gives R a weighted total of 7.8?

- A. 3.6
- B. 9
- C. 7.8
- D. 1.44

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A sponsor cuts a project's budget by 20% but insists that scope and quality stay the same. The project was featured in the company newsletter last month. What must the project manager explain?

- A. The schedule will shorten, since less money means less work.
- B. Nothing else changes; a good manager absorbs the cut.
- C. The newsletter visibility will protect the project from impact.
- D. The schedule will likely lengthen, or scope or quality will have to give, because the constraints are linked.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A team of five engineers can do either Project Alpha (expected value \$400,000) or Project Beta (expected value \$350,000), but not both. Beta was requested by a long-time client. If Alpha is chosen, what is the opportunity cost?

- A.** \$50,000
- B.** \$350,000
- C.** \$400,000
- D.** \$750,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A CRM project finished on time and on budget, and every feature passed testing. The go-live party was held at a rooftop restaurant. Six months later, sales-rep adoption is 30% and sales cycle time is unchanged. How should the project's strategic success be judged?

- A.** Outputs were delivered, but the intended business outcomes were not realized.
- B.** A success, because the launch event was well attended.
- C.** A failure, because any CRM without 100% adoption always fails.
- D.** A success, because it met time, cost, and scope.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A company's strategy is to become the lowest-cost provider in its market. Four projects are proposed: (A) automate warehouse picking to cut labor costs 18%; (B) launch a luxury premium line; (C) redesign the corporate logo; (D) sponsor a regional golf tournament. ~~Project B's sponsor is the longest-serving vice president.~~ Which project best aligns with the strategy?

Target word: best strategic fit **Decides:** The strategy is cost leadership.

A	Camouflage	Seniority does not create strategic fit; a luxury line works against cost leadership.
B	Absolute language	Projects differ in how much they advance strategy.
C	Correct	Directly lowers operating cost, the heart of a low-cost strategy.
D	Adjacent category	Branding work does not reduce cost.

2. Answer D Concept 2

Two mutually exclusive projects are proposed. Project X has an NPV of \$120,000 and costs \$500,000. Project Y has an NPV of \$90,000 and costs \$200,000. ~~X's team lead just won a company award.~~ Capital is not limited beyond choosing one. Which should be chosen on value?

Target word: choice between mutually exclusive projects **Decides:** Higher NPV when capital is not rationed.

A	Adjacent category	NPV per dollar (profitability index) is for capital rationing, which the stem rules out.
B	Dropped element	Drops the value created.
C	Absolute language	Positive NPV already means value is created.
D	Correct	X adds \$30,000 more value.

3. Answer A Concept 2 · transfer

A project costs \$100,000 today and returns \$60,000 at the end of each of the next two years. At a 10% discount rate, what is its NPV?

Target word: compute NPV **Decides:** Discount each inflow, then subtract the cost.

A	Correct	$\$60,000 / 1.10 + \$60,000 / 1.21 = \$54,545 + \$49,587 = \$104,132$; minus \$100,000 = \$4,132.
B	Adjacent category	Present value of inflows, before subtracting the cost.
C	Dropped element	Ignores discounting.
D	Inverted operation	Subtracts in the wrong order.

4. Answer C Concept 3

A software upgrade costs \$150,000. It saves \$50,000 in each of years 1 and 2 and \$100,000 in year 3. ~~The vendor offers free training in the first month.~~ What is the payback period?

Target word: payback period **Decides:** Uneven cash flows; count cumulatively.

A	Wrong stem number	Divides by the year-3 figure as if it applied every year.
B	Inverted operation	Divides annual savings by cost.
C	Correct	After 2 years, \$100,000 recovered; the remaining \$50,000 is half of year 3's \$100,000.
D	Dropped element	Assumes \$50,000 every year and drops the larger year-3 savings.

5. Answer A Concept 3 • transfer

Project M pays back in 2 years. Project N pays back in 3 years but produces much larger cash flows after year 3. What is the main weakness of choosing M on payback alone?

Target word: limit of payback **Decides:** Payback ignores post-payback cash flows.

A	Correct	N's larger later flows are invisible to payback.
B	Absolute language	Payback measures speed of recovery, not total value.
C	Inverted operation	It ignores them rather than overstating them.
D	Confusion set	Payback is a liquidity measure, not profitability.

6. Answer D Concept 4

A training program cost \$80,000 and produced measurable gains of \$104,000 in its first year. ~~The program was delivered at a resort venue.~~ What is the first-year ROI?

Target word: ROI **Decides:** ROI = (gain – cost) / cost.

A	Inverted operation	Divides the net gain by the gain instead of the cost.
B	Dropped element	Gain / cost without subtracting the cost.
C	Adjacent category	Net gain in dollars, not a return ratio.
D	Correct	$(\$104,000 - \$80,000) / \$80,000 = 0.30$.

7. Answer C Concept 4 • transfer

A project must deliver a 25% ROI. It will cost \$240,000. What total gain is required?

Target word: solve for gain **Decides:** Gain = cost × (1 + ROI).

A	Adjacent category	That is the net gain, not total gain.
B	Wrong stem number	That is the cost, which gives 0% ROI.
C	Correct	$\$240,000 \times 1.25 = \$300,000$.
D	Inverted operation	Reduces cost by 20% instead of adding a 25% return.

8. Answer B Concept 5

A PMO scores projects with weights Strategic fit 50%, Cost 30%, Risk 20%. Project P scores 9, 5, 4. Project Q scores 5, 8, 8. ~~Q was proposed by the marketing team, which beat its targets last year.~~ Which project ranks higher?

Target word: higher weighted score **Decides:** Apply the weights.

A	Camouflage	Past team results are not a scoring criterion.
B	Correct	P: $4.5 + 1.5 + 0.8 = 6.8$. Q: $2.5 + 2.4 + 1.6 = 6.5$.
C	Dropped element	Adds raw scores and drops the weights.
D	Confusion set	Swaps the two projects' weighted totals.

9. Answer B Concept 5 · transfer

A model weights Fit at 60% and Cost at 40%. Project R scores 7 on Fit. What Cost score gives R a weighted total of 7.8?

Target word: solve for a missing score **Decides:** $0.6 \times 7 = 4.2$; remaining 3.6 must come from Cost.

A	Dropped element	Forgets to divide by the weight.
B	Correct	$(7.8 - 4.2) / 0.4 = 9$.
C	Wrong stem number	That is the target total.
D	Inverted operation	Multiplies 3.6 by 0.4 instead of dividing.

10. Answer D Concept 6

A sponsor cuts a project's budget by 20% but insists that scope and quality stay the same. ~~The project was featured in the company newsletter last month.~~ What must the project manager explain?

Target word: consequence of a constraint change **Decides:** Constraints are linked.

A	Inverted operation	Scope is unchanged, so the work is not less.
B	Absolute language	Trade-offs cannot be wished away.
C	Camouflage	Publicity does not change the constraints.
D	Correct	A cost cut must be balanced somewhere.

11. Answer B Concept 7

A team of five engineers can do either Project Alpha (expected value \$400,000) or Project Beta (expected value \$350,000), but not both. ~~Beta was requested by a long time client.~~ If Alpha is chosen, what is the opportunity cost?

Target word: opportunity cost **Decides:** Value of the best option given up.

A	Adjacent category	The net advantage of Alpha, not the opportunity cost.
B	Correct	Beta's value is given up.
C	Inverted operation	That is the value of the option chosen.
D	Confusion set	Adds both options.

12. Answer A Concept 8

A CRM project finished on time and on budget, and every feature passed testing. ~~The go-live party was held at a rooftop restaurant.~~ Six months later, sales-rep adoption is 30% and sales cycle time is unchanged. How should the project's strategic success be judged?

Target word: strategic success **Decides:** Business benefits were not realized.

A	Correct	Strategic success is measured by benefits.
B	Camouflage	Event turnout is not a business outcome.
C	Absolute language	Full adoption is not the test; the planned benefits are.
D	Adjacent category	That is project-management success, not strategic success.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	6	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	3	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	3	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	4	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Strategic alignment	Projects are chosen by how directly they advance the organization's stated strategy.	Choosing by sponsor seniority or assuming every project adds equal value.	A stated strategy followed by a list of proposals.
2	Net present value	NPV = PV of future cash flows – initial cost; for mutually exclusive projects with no capital limit, pick the higher NPV.	Picking by lower cost or NPV per dollar when capital is not rationed.	Mutually exclusive projects with NPVs given.
3	Payback period	Payback is the time to recover the initial cost from cash flows; it ignores cash flows after payback and the time value of money.	Assuming shorter payback always means higher value.	Uneven yearly cash flows and “how long to recover.”
4	Return on investment	ROI = (gain – cost) / cost.	Dividing gain by cost or dividing by the gain.	A cost and a total gain.
5	Weighted scoring model	Multiply each criterion score by its weight and sum; the highest weighted total wins.	Adding raw scores and ignoring weights.	Criteria with percentage weights.
6	Constraint trade-offs	Scope, schedule, cost, and quality are linked; tightening one forces change in another.	Believing a cut can be absorbed with no trade-off.	One constraint cut while others are held fixed.
7	Opportunity cost	Opportunity cost is the value of the best alternative given up.	Using the difference between options or the chosen option's value.	Two options that cannot both be done.
8	Outputs vs. outcomes	Delivering on time and budget is project success; strategic success requires the intended business benefits to be realized.	Declaring success because the deliverables shipped.	On-time delivery followed by weak adoption or results.

Course scope (public description): In Strategic Project Management and Decision-Making, learners will align project approaches with organizational strategy, ensuring maximum value creation and stakeholder satisfaction. Learners will hone their analytical skills to make informed decisions and tackle complex project management challenges within specified constraints. By delving into real-world scenarios, learners will develop the acumen to evaluate complex situations and determine the most efficient and effective course of action, fostering strategic thinking and agility in project management practices.